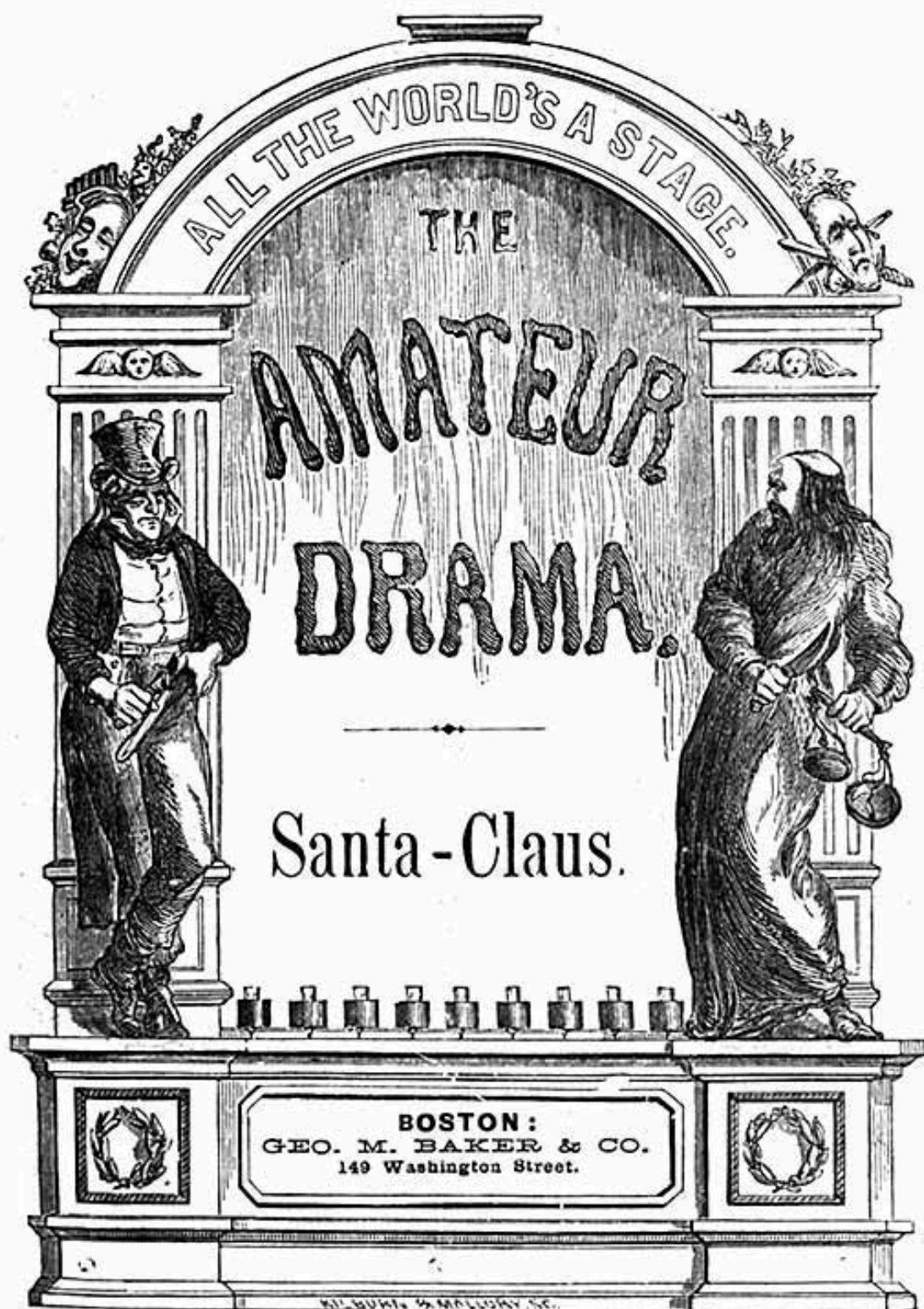


ALL THE WORLD'S A STAGE.

THE
AMATEUR
DRAMA.

Santa-Claus.

BOSTON :
GEO. M. BAKER & CO.
149 Washington Street.



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FROLICS ***

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SANTA CLAUS' FROLICS.

BY THE AUTHOR OF

"Sylvia's Soldier;" "Once on a Time;" "Down by the Sea;" "Bread on
the Waters;" "The Last Loaf;" "Stand by the Flag;" "The Tempter;" "A
Drop Too Much;" "We're All Teetotallers;" "A Little More Cider;"
"Thirty Minutes for Refreshments;" "Wanted, a Male Cook;" "A
Sea of Troubles;" "Freedom of the Press;" "A Close Shave;"
"The Great Elixir;" "The Man with the Demijohn;" "New
Brooms Sweep Clean;" "Rumors of the Strike;" "My
Uncle the Captain;" "The Greatest Plague in Life;"
"No Cure, No Pay;" "The Grecian Bend;" "The
War of the Roses;" "Lightheart's Pilgrimage;"
"The Sculptor's Triumph;" "Too Late for
the Train;" "Snow-Bound;" "The
Peddler of Very Nice;" "Bonbons;"
"Capuletta;" "An Original
Idea;" &c.

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SANTA CLAUS' FROLICS.

A CHRISTMAS ENTERTAINMENT FOR LITTLE FOLKS.

[The rising of the curtain discloses room, with a fireplace, c., on either side or above which are hung stockings of various sizes, from the baby's little sock to Bridget's long and broad red, blue, or black hose. On the right of the fireplace is the Christmas tree, hidden by a curtain, which is so arranged that it may be easily removed (or, if double parlors are used, or the entertainment is given in a hall or vestry, the tree can be placed in one corner of the audience-room, and while the attention of the auditors is diverted by the entertainment in the other room, or upon the platform, the tree can be lighted). Six or eight children in the scene, arrayed in night dresses and caps, with lighted candles in their hands, moving about, and occasionally looking up chimney.]

SONG.—Air, "We're all Noddin'."

Girls.

We're all waiting, wait, wait, waiting,
We're all waiting for Santa Claus to come.
To catch him we're waiting; he'll surely be here;
The moments fly quickly, and midnight draws near.

All.

We're all waiting, wait, wait, waiting,
We're all waiting for Santa Claus to come.

Boys.

We're all freezing, freeze, freeze, freezing,
We're all freezing, here, waiting in the cold;
For Santa to bring us our presents we wait;
Come, hurry, old fellow; 'tis really quite late.

All.

We're all freezing, freeze, freeze, freezing,
We're all freezing, here, waiting in the cold.

Girls.

We're all nodding, nod, nod, nodding,
We're all nodding, and dropping off to sleep;
To our warm little beds 'tis time we should go;
Come, hurry, good Santa; pray don't be so slow.

All.

For we're all nodding, nod, nod, nodding,
For we're all nodding, and dropping off to sleep.

Boys.

We're all yawning, yaw, yaw, yawning,
We're all yawning; so let's go off to bed.

Girls.

To stay any longer we're surely unwise;
We'll wait for the daylight to open our eyes.

All.

For we're all yawning, yaw, yaw, yawning,
We're all yawning, and going off to bed.

[*Exeunt, R. and L., repeating the last two lines.*]

Santa Claus peeps out from chimney, then enters. Costume, rubber boots, with pants tucked into them; heavy fur coat, with red comforter tied about it; red comforter about his neck; peaked fur cap; long gray hair and beard; very red face; strapped to his back a large basket, filled with toys.

Santa (looking R. and L.).

Ho, ho, my little rogues. You set a trap
To catch me napping; *now* who takes the nap?
I'm an old schemer; even your sharp eyes
Could never find me in this queer disguise.
Dream on, my darlings, while I treasures heap.
Ho, ho! to fill your *hose* while you're asleep.
Year after year, I drop in on the sly,
Through chimneys made for me so broad and high;
To pop down them is made my cheerful duty;
It *suits* me too—sometimes, almost too sooty.

(Takes basket off back.)

Let's see: what year is this? why bless my eyes,
It's 1872.—Good Gracious! how time flies!
And children multiply so fast, 'tis clear,
A partner I must have another year.
I'm really getting old. This wrinkled phiz
Of good old age a striking symbol is.
And yet I'm strong, can frolic, dance, or play
With young folks yet for many a Christmas day.
So I'll not grumble; while I can, I'll strive
To let my boys and girls know I'm alive.
What though my hair is gray, my heart is young,
And green as Christmas boughs around me hung.

SONG.—Santa Claus. Air, "*Captain Jinks.*"

I'm Santa Claus, the Christmas king,
And every year I gayly sing,
Ho, boys and girls, to you I bring
Such lots of Christmas Presents;
A clipper sled, for merry Ned,
For merry Ned, for merry Ned,
A waxen doll, for pretty Poll,
You'll find among my treasures.

(Spoken.) But, bless you, I don't sing very loud, for I know that "Little pitchers have big ears," and I wouldn't have them hear me for the world. Ah, many and many a time I've heard a soft voice in the middle of the night, cry out, "Who's there?" Ah, ha! Then I creep about softly, and sing very low,—

I'm Santa Claus, &c.

The boys and girls in me delight,
In me delight, in me delight;
They hang their stockings in the night
To wait my midnight coming.
With generous store I fill them all,
I fill them all, I fill them all;
With generous store I fill them all,
And creep off in the morning.

(Spoken.) For, bless the dear little rogues, they're only half asleep. Wouldn't they like to catch me! But no, no, I'm away up the chimney, and when morning comes I peep in, and hear them cry, "Why, who has been here, and left these beautiful presents?" Ah, ha! then I sing,—

Why, Santa Claus, the Christmas king,
Who every year doth gayly sing, &c.

(Children sing outside.)

We're all dreaming, dream, dream, dreaming,
We're all dreaming that Santa Claus has come.

Santa.

Dream on, my darlings, unto each of you
Morn shall bring joy; your dreams shall all be true.
Here are the stockings; bless me, what a row!
Little and big, they make a wondrous show.

(As he speaks he fills stockings.)

First comes the baby's; what a tiny thing!
'Twill just hold a rattle and a rubber ring;
This is a girl's, so very neat and small;
I'll stuff it with candy, and a pretty doll.
Ah! here's a boy's. It's very strong and blue.
A nice new pair of skates, my lad, for you;
Another girl's. What can I find to please her?
Ah, here's a tea set; don't think that's a *teaser*.
Another boy's! Ho, this will never do,—
Hole in the heel; a present would drop through;
A ball of yarn will make him wiser grow;
'Twill mend his stocking and his habits too.
What monster's this? It must be Bridget's, sure;
'Twould hold all I have brought, I fear much more.
A nice new gingham dress—a good warm shawl—
Don't fill it—then here goes a waterfall.

And now I'm off. *(Sees audience.)* Hallo! whom have we here?

I really am found out; that's very clear.
Now don't expose me, for I did not mean
Upon my annual visit to be seen.
If you are all my children, 'tis not fair
To tell my secrets even to the air;
So keep them close; don't whisper I've been here;
And shut your eyes; I'm going to disappear.
With "Merry Christmas" wishes all I greet,
Hoping next year my visit to repeat.
And now good night—I'm off. Yet ere I go,
A little magic I propose to show.
Shut fast your eyes a minute—one, two, three.
Presto! change! Behold the Christmas tree.

(The Christmas tree is suddenly disclosed. Santa Claus approaches it, and distributes presents.)

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The first page of Spencer's catalog originally located in the front of the book has been moved to the back of the book with the balance of the catalog pages.

The author's and publisher's use of spelling has been maintained, except in the following cases:

The spelling of "Teetotallers" in the title "We're all Teetotallers" has been changed in two places; from both Tretotaller and Teetotalers as originally printed.

In item 51 of Spencer's booklist, the word Farcé has been changed to Farce.

Spellings of the names of the following authors listed in Spencer's catalog have been maintained, however it is noted to the reader they differ from other published sources:

Montague Williams has been noted as Montagu Williams in other sources.

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